JOESIAH
&
MALANI

FROM ABRAHAM TO MOSES

THE JOURNEY TO FREEDOM

BOOK 2

God keeps His promises, even when it takes generations.

Written by

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Joesiah & Malani: From Abraham to Moses — The Journey to Freedom

Joesiah & Malani, Book 2

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CHAPTER 1

Back to the Promise

Joesiah couldn't sit still. "Grandma, are we going to meet Moses now?"

Grandma smiled and unrolled the old family-tree scroll across the table. "Soon. But to understand how God set His people free, we have to go back to a promise He made long before Moses was born."

Malani climbed onto Grandma's lap. "A promise!"

Grandma's finger traced the names. "Remember Noah's son Shem? Generations passed through his family line. Then we come to a man named Terah."

She pointed to three names under Terah: Abram, Nahor and Haran.

"Abram," Joesiah read slowly. "Is that Abraham?"

"It will be," Grandma said. "But not yet."

The Bible tells us that Terah's family lived in **Ur of the Chaldeans**. Terah took his son Abram, Abram's wife **Sarai**, and his grandson **Lot**, and they set out for the land of Canaan. But when they reached a place called **Haran**, they settled there.

Scripture also tells us something important about Abram and Sarai:

> *"Now Sarai was childless because she was not able to conceive."*
>
> —Genesis 11:30

Joesiah frowned. "But Grandma, if they didn't have any children, how could their family become a whole nation?"

Grandma's eyes sparkled. "That is exactly the right question. Hold on to it. The answer is the whole story of this book."

ON TODAY'S MAP

Ur: an ancient city in what is now **southern Iraq**. Most scholars connect it with "Ur of the Chaldeans." Some suggest other places.

Haran: near the town of **Harran in southeastern Turkey**.

Malani pointed at the long road on the map between Ur and Haran. "Far!"

"Very far," Grandma said. "And Abram's journey was only beginning. Sometimes God's promises start in the places where it looks impossible."

Know the Word. Seek the Truth. Remember who you are. Walk in the purpose God gave you.

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READ IT FOR YOURSELF

Genesis 11:10–32

ILLUSTRATION COMING

CHAPTER 1

Back to the Promise

Grandma, Joesiah & Malani at the family-tree scroll; a glowing path from Shem to Abram; a dreamlike view of Ur and the road to Haran.

Art size: 2,550 × 3,400 px or larger · no text in the artwork

CHAPTER 2

Abram Answers the Call

Grandma turned the scroll to a new page. "One day, while Abram was living in Haran, God spoke to him."

> *"Go from your country, your people and your father's household to the land I will show you. I will make you into a great nation, and I will bless you… and all peoples on earth will be blessed through you."*
>
> —Genesis 12:1–3

Joesiah's eyes went wide. "A great nation? But Grandma, Abram and Sarai didn't have any children!"

"You remembered," Grandma said proudly. "Abram didn't know *how* God would do it. He didn't even know *where* he was going. God only said, 'to the land I will show you.'"

"So what did he do?"

"He went."

Abram was seventy-five years old when he left Haran. He took his wife Sarai, his nephew Lot, everything they owned, and the people who lived and worked with them, and they set out for the land of **Canaan**.

Malani giggled. "Seventy-five! Older than Grandma!"

Grandma laughed. "Much older than Grandma."

Joesiah sat up straight. "Wait. Canaan! We learned about Canaan in the first book!"

"We did," Grandma said. "Now Abram was walking into that land. The Canaanites were living there. But at a place called Shechem, God appeared to Abram again and said, 'To your offspring I will give this land.'"

Abram built an altar to the Lord there. Later, near Bethel, he built another altar and called on the name of the Lord. Wherever Abram traveled, he made room to worship God.

Joesiah thought for a moment. "Grandma, Abram obeyed before he understood."

"That's faith," Grandma said softly. "Faith means taking the next step, even before you can see the whole road."

She pointed again to the words *all peoples on earth*. "And remember this part. God's promise to Abram wasn't only for one family. It was meant to become a blessing for families everywhere."

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READ IT FOR YOURSELF

Genesis 12:1–9

ILLUSTRATION COMING

CHAPTER 2

Abram Answers the Call

Sunrise: Abram, Sarai, Lot and the caravan set out from Haran; the children walk alongside.

Art size: 2,550 × 3,400 px or larger · no text in the artwork

CHAPTER 3

A Sky Full of Stars

Years passed. Abram had moved to Canaan, built altars, and trusted God. But he and Sarai still had no children.

Then the word of the Lord came to Abram in a vision:

> *"Do not be afraid, Abram. I am your shield, your very great reward."*
>
> —Genesis 15:1

Abram was honest with God. He said that he still had no child, and that a servant in his household would one day receive everything he owned.

Joesiah nodded slowly. "He told God how he really felt."

"He did," Grandma said. "You can bring God your honest questions."

Then God took Abram outside, under the night sky.

> *"Look up at the sky and count the stars—if indeed you can count them… So shall your offspring be."*
>
> —Genesis 15:5

Malani leaned back and pointed upward. "One… two… three… four… TOO MANY!"

Everyone laughed.

"That's exactly the point," Grandma said. "Abram couldn't count them. And God's promise was bigger than anything Abram could count."

Scripture says:

> *"Abram believed the LORD, and he credited it to him as righteousness."*
>
> —Genesis 15:6

Many more years went by. When Abram was ninety-nine years old, God appeared to him again and confirmed His covenant, a sacred promise. God gave Abram a new name: **Abraham**, which means "father of many."

> *"No longer will you be called Abram; your name will be Abraham, for I have made you a father of many nations."*
>
> —Genesis 17:5

God also changed Sarai's name to **Sarah** and promised that she would have a son. God even told them the baby's name: **Isaac**.

Joesiah's mouth dropped open. "God named the baby before he was born?"

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READ IT FOR YOURSELF

Genesis 15:1–6 and Genesis 17:1–8, 15–19

ILLUSTRATION COMING

CHAPTER 3

A Sky Full of Stars

Night in the desert: Abram outside his tent beneath a sky blazing with stars; Malani tries to count them.

Art size: 2,550 × 3,400 px or larger · no text in the artwork

CHAPTER 4

Hagar — The God Who Sees

"Grandma," Joesiah asked, "what happened during all those years of waiting?"

Grandma's voice grew gentle. "Something hard. And the Bible doesn't hide it."

Sarai had a servant named **Hagar**. Scripture tells us she was **Egyptian**, and she was not free; she was an enslaved woman in Abram's household. Sarai grew tired of waiting for God's promise, so she decided to build a family her own way. She gave Hagar to Abram as a wife, and Hagar became pregnant.

Soon there was trouble in the home. Sarai mistreated Hagar, and Hagar ran away into the wilderness.

Malani's face fell. "All alone?"

"She thought she was alone," Grandma said. "But she wasn't."

By a spring of water on the road toward Shur, the angel of the Lord found Hagar. He called her by name. He told her that God would give her more descendants than anyone could count, and that her son should be named **Ishmael**, which means "God hears," because the Lord had heard of her misery.

Then Hagar did something amazing. She gave God a name:

> *"You are the God who sees me."*
>
> —Genesis 16:13

In Hebrew, this name is **El Roi**.

Joesiah was quiet for a moment. "Nobody saw what was happening to her. But God did."

"That's right," Grandma said. "People overlooked Hagar. God did not."

Years later, Hagar and Ishmael found themselves in the wilderness again, near Beersheba. Their water ran out, and Ishmael was crying. But Scripture says God heard the boy, and God opened Hagar's eyes to see a well of water. God was with Ishmael as he grew up.

Grandma squeezed both their hands. "Notice something else. One of the very first people in the Bible to give God a name was an Egyptian woman from Africa."

ON TODAY'S MAP

Shur: a desert region in the northern Sinai Peninsula, between Egypt and Canaan.
Beersheba: still a city today, in southern Israel.

▼ TEXT CONTINUES — chapter is about 5 words too long for one page ▼

READ IT FOR YOURSELF

Genesis 16 and Genesis 21:8–21

ILLUSTRATION COMING

CHAPTER 4

Hagar — The God Who Sees

Hagar, a young Egyptian woman, kneels by a desert spring in soft heavenly light.

Art size: 2,550 × 3,400 px or larger · no text in the artwork

CHAPTER 5

Isaac, the Son of Laughter

Grandma's eyes twinkled. "Remember the baby God named before he was born?"

"Isaac!" Malani shouted.

Just as God had promised, Sarah had a son. Abraham was one hundred years old! They named him **Isaac**, which means "he laughs."

> *"God has brought me laughter, and everyone who hears about this will laugh with me."*
>
> —Genesis 21:6

Joesiah grinned. "So the promise finally came true!"

"It did," Grandma said. "But Isaac's story has a very serious part too. I'll tell it carefully."

When Isaac was older, God tested Abraham. God told him to take Isaac, his only son whom he loved, up a mountain in the region of Moriah and offer him as a sacrifice.

Joesiah's face fell. "Grandma... why would God ask that?"

Grandma held his hand. "That's an important question. The Bible says it was a *test*, a test of whether Abraham trusted God more than anything, even the gift God had given him. Listen to what happened."

As they climbed the mountain, Isaac carried the wood and asked his father, "Where is the lamb?"

Abraham answered:

> *"God himself will provide the lamb for the burnt offering, my son."*
>
> —Genesis 22:8

At the top of the mountain, before anything could happen to Isaac, the angel of the Lord called out: "Do not lay a hand on the boy!" Abraham looked up and saw a ram caught by its horns in a bush. God had provided.

Abraham named that place **"The Lord Will Provide."**

Joesiah let out a long breath. "God never let anything happen to Isaac."

"No, He didn't," Grandma said. "Many Bible teachers point out that in Abraham's day, some nations offered their children to their gods. This story shows that the God of Abraham is different. He stopped it, and He provided."

Malani snuggled closer. "God provides."

"Always," Grandma said. "Even when we can't see how yet."

▼ TEXT CONTINUES — chapter is about 25 words too long for one page ▼

READ IT FOR YOURSELF

Genesis 21:1–7 and Genesis 22:1–14

ILLUSTRATION COMING

CHAPTER 5

Isaac, the Son of Laughter

Mountaintop at dawn: Abraham and young Isaac see the ram caught in the thicket. God provides.

Art size: 2,550 × 3,400 px or larger · no text in the artwork

CHAPTER 6

Rebekah and the Twins

When Isaac was grown, Abraham sent his most trusted servant on a long journey back to the land where Abraham's relatives lived. His mission: to find a wife for Isaac.

The servant traveled with ten camels. When he reached a well outside the town, he prayed. He asked God to show him the right young woman: the one who would offer water not only to him, but to his camels too.

Before he had even finished praying, a young woman named **Rebekah** came to the well with her water jar.

> *"Drink, my lord… I'll draw water for your camels too, until they have had enough to drink."*
>
> —Genesis 24:18–19

Joesiah's eyes widened. "Ten camels? Grandma, camels drink a LOT of water!"

"They do," Grandma laughed. "Rebekah went back and forth to that well again and again. She was kind and hardworking, and she didn't even know anyone was watching."

Malani wiggled her fingers. "Water, water, water!"

The servant knew God had answered his prayer. Rebekah agreed to travel to Canaan, and she became Isaac's wife. The Bible says Isaac loved her.

For many years, Isaac and Rebekah had no children, just like Abraham and Sarah. Isaac prayed for his wife, and God answered: Rebekah was going to have **twins**.

Even before they were born, the twins seemed to struggle with each other! Rebekah asked the Lord why, and God answered her:

> *"Two nations are in your womb, and two peoples from within you will be separated; one people will be stronger than the other, and the older will serve the younger."*
>
> —Genesis 25:23

Joesiah blinked. "God told her the future before the babies were even born?"

"He did," Grandma said. "Keep listening. You'll see those words come true."

When the twins were born, the first was born red and hairy, and they named him **Esau**. The second came out holding his brother's heel, and they named him **Jacob**.

As the boys grew, Esau became a skilled hunter who loved the open country. Jacob was quieter and stayed near the tents. Scripture says Isaac loved Esau more, and Rebekah loved Jacob more.

Joesiah frowned. "Parents having favorites? That sounds like trouble."

▼ TEXT CONTINUES — chapter is about 145 words too long for one page ▼

READ IT FOR YOURSELF

Genesis 24 and Genesis 25:19–34

ILLUSTRATION COMING

CHAPTER 6

Rebekah and the Twins

Rebekah at the well, watering ten camels; Abraham's servant watches in amazement.

Art size: 2,550 × 3,400 px or larger · no text in the artwork

CHAPTER 7

A Ladder to Heaven and a New Name

Esau was so angry about the stolen blessing that Jacob had to run away from home. He set out alone toward Haran, where his mother's family lived.

When night came, Jacob lay down in the open with a stone under his head. Then he had a dream. He saw a stairway resting on the earth with its top reaching to heaven, and the angels of God were going up and down on it.

The Lord stood above it and gave Jacob the same promise He had given Abraham and Isaac. Then God said:

> *"I am with you and will watch over you wherever you go."*
>
> —Genesis 28:15

Joesiah shook his head. "Even after Jacob tricked his family, God still came to him?"

"God still came to him," Grandma said. "That's grace. But Jacob had a lot of growing to do."

When Jacob woke up, he said, "Surely the Lord is in this place, and I was not aware of it." He named the place **Bethel**, which means "house of God."

In Haran, Jacob worked for his uncle Laban for twenty years. Laban tricked Jacob more than once.

Malani's eyes went big. "The tricker got tricked!"

"He sure did," Grandma laughed. "Jacob learned how it felt."

During those years, Jacob married Leah and Rachel, and his family grew large. At last, God told Jacob to go home. But going home meant facing Esau, and Jacob was afraid.

The night before he met his brother, Jacob was alone by the Jabbok River. A mysterious man wrestled with him until daybreak. Jacob would not let go.

> *"I will not let you go unless you bless me."*
>
> —Genesis 32:26

The man gave Jacob a new name:

> *"Your name will no longer be Jacob, but Israel, because you have struggled with God and with humans and have overcome."*
>
> —Genesis 32:28

The next morning, Esau ran to meet Jacob. He threw his arms around his brother, and they both wept.

▼ TEXT CONTINUES — chapter is about 90 words too long for one page ▼

READ IT FOR YOURSELF

Genesis 28:10–22, Genesis 32:22–30 and Genesis 33:1–4

ILLUSTRATION COMING

CHAPTER 7

A Ladder to Heaven and a New Name

Jacob asleep on a stone; a glowing stairway with angels rises into the stars.

Art size: 2,550 × 3,400 px or larger · no text in the artwork

CHAPTER 8

Twelve Sons, Twelve Tribes

Grandma unrolled the family tree again. Under the name **Israel**, twelve new names spread out like branches.

"These are Jacob's twelve sons," she said.

REUBEN • SIMEON • LEVI • JUDAH • DAN • NAPHTALI • GAD • ASHER • ISSACHAR • ZEBULUN • JOSEPH • BENJAMIN

"Their families would one day become the **twelve tribes of Israel**."

Malani jumped up and pointed. "JOSEPH!"

Everyone laughed.

"Yes, we know Joseph!" Grandma said. "Remember? His jealous brothers sold him, and he was taken to Egypt. He served faithfully, even in prison. Then God gave him wisdom to explain Pharaoh's dreams, and Joseph became a leader who saved many lives during the famine. In the end, Joseph forgave his brothers, and Jacob's whole family came to live in Egypt."

"We learned all that in the first book!" Joesiah said.

"You did. But here's something we didn't talk about." Grandma pointed to a smaller name beside Joseph's.

"In Egypt, Joseph married a woman named **Asenath**. She was the daughter of an Egyptian priest in the city of **On**. Joseph and Asenath had two sons, **Manasseh** and **Ephraim**."

Joesiah studied the tree. "So their mother was Egyptian."

"That's right," Grandma said. "Now listen to what Jacob did when he was very old."

Jacob, also called Israel, asked Joseph to bring the boys to him. Then Jacob said:

> *"Ephraim and Manasseh will be mine, just as Reuben and Simeon are mine."*
>
> —Genesis 48:5

Jacob placed his hands on their heads to bless them. But he crossed his arms and put his right hand, the hand of the greater blessing, on the younger boy, Ephraim.

Joesiah gasped. "The older will serve the younger! Just like God told Rebekah!"

"You remembered!" Grandma said. "God's plan kept showing up in surprising ways."

Because of Jacob's blessing, Ephraim and Manasseh each became a tribe of Israel.

▼ TEXT CONTINUES — chapter is about 105 words too long for one page ▼

READ IT FOR YOURSELF

Genesis 35:22–26, Genesis 41:50–52 and Genesis 48

ILLUSTRATION COMING

CHAPTER 8

Twelve Sons, Twelve Tribes

Old Jacob crosses his arms to bless Ephraim and Manasseh; Joseph and Asenath beside them.

Art size: 2,550 × 3,400 px or larger · no text in the artwork

CHAPTER 9

A New King Who Did Not Know Joseph

Many years passed. Joseph and his brothers died. But their children had children, and those children had children. The family of Israel grew so large that the land of Goshen was filled with them.

Then something changed.

> *"Then a new king, to whom Joseph meant nothing, came to power in Egypt."*
>
> —Exodus 1:8

Joesiah sat up. "We heard that verse at the end of the first book!"

"You have a good memory," Grandma said. "Now we find out what happened next."

The new Pharaoh looked at the Israelites and became afraid. *What if they grow too strong? What if they join our enemies?* So he put slave masters over them and forced them to do hard labor. They made bricks and built whole cities for Pharaoh.

But Scripture says something remarkable:

> *"But the more they were oppressed, the more they multiplied and spread."*
>
> —Exodus 1:12

Joesiah frowned. "Grandma, the Israelites were enslaved?"

"They were," Grandma said quietly. "The Bible tells the truth about suffering. It doesn't hide it."

"But in the first book, Egypt was a great civilization," Joesiah said.

"It was," Grandma said. "And both things are true. This cruelty came from a ruler who let **fear** rule his heart. A ruler's choices don't tell the whole story of a people. Watch who shows courage next."

Pharaoh gave an even more terrible order. He told the midwives, the women who helped mothers when babies were born, to harm every baby boy born to the Israelites.

But two midwives named **Shiphrah** and **Puah** refused.

> *"The midwives, however, feared God and did not do what the king of Egypt told them; they let the boys live."*
>
> —Exodus 1:17

"The Bible calls them Hebrew midwives," Grandma said. "But some readers wonder whether they were Egyptian women who helped Hebrew mothers. Either way, they feared God."

▼ TEXT CONTINUES — chapter is about 170 words too long for one page ▼

READ IT FOR YOURSELF

Exodus 1

ILLUSTRATION COMING

CHAPTER 9

A New King Who Did Not Know Joseph

Shiphrah and Puah stand calm and courageous before Pharaoh's throne.

Art size: 2,550 × 3,400 px or larger · no text in the artwork

CHAPTER 10

A Baby in a Basket

Pharaoh's cruelty didn't stop. He ordered that every Hebrew baby boy be thrown into the Nile River.

Malani hid her face in Grandma's arm.

"I know," Grandma said softly. "It's hard to hear. But hold on. This is where God starts something beautiful."

A Hebrew woman from the family of Levi gave birth to a baby boy. Scripture says she saw that he was a fine child, so she hid him for three months. When she couldn't hide him any longer, she made a basket out of papyrus reeds and coated it with tar and pitch so it would float. She placed her baby inside and set the basket among the reeds along the bank of the Nile.

The baby's big sister stood at a distance to watch what would happen to him. Later in the Bible, we learn her name: **Miriam**. We also learn their mother's name: **Jochebed**.

Then Pharaoh's daughter, an Egyptian princess, came down to the river to bathe. She saw the basket among the reeds and sent her servant to get it. When she opened it, the baby was crying.

> *"She felt sorry for him. 'This is one of the Hebrew babies,' she said."*
>
> —EXODUS 2:6

Joesiah leaned forward. "Pharaoh's own daughter?"

"Pharaoh's own daughter," Grandma said. "Remember what I told you? Watch who shows courage."

Then Miriam bravely stepped forward. "Shall I go and get one of the Hebrew women to nurse the baby for you?"

The princess said yes, and Miriam ran and got... the baby's own mother!

Malani gasped. "His MOMMY!"

"His mommy," Grandma laughed. "Jochebed got to hold her son again, and the princess even paid her to take care of him."

When the boy grew older, his mother brought him to Pharaoh's daughter, and he became her son. She named him **Moses**, saying, "I drew him out of the water."

Joesiah's eyes lit up. "MOSES! The baby from the end of the first book!"

"The very same," Grandma said. "And later, the Bible tells us Moses was educated in all the wisdom of the Egyptians."

▼ TEXT CONTINUES — chapter is about 60 words too long for one page ▼

READ IT FOR YOURSELF

Exodus 2:1–10 and Acts 7:20–22

ILLUSTRATION COMING

CHAPTER 10

A Baby in a Basket

Pharaoh's daughter lifts baby Moses' basket from the Nile; Miriam peeks from the reeds.

Art size: 2,550 × 3,400 px or larger · no text in the artwork

CHAPTER 11

The Burning Bush

Moses grew up in Pharaoh's palace. But he never forgot that he was a Hebrew.

One day, Moses saw an Egyptian beating a Hebrew worker. Moses rushed in to stop him, but he acted in anger, and the Egyptian lost his life. When Pharaoh heard what had happened, he was furious, so Moses ran away to the land of **Midian**.

Joesiah's eyes went wide. "Moses got in that much trouble?"

"He did," Grandma said gently. "Moses wanted to protect his people, but he acted in anger instead of waiting on God. The Bible tells the truth about its heroes, even their mistakes. And God still had a plan for Moses."

In Midian, Moses sat down by a well. When some shepherds chased away seven sisters who had come to water their flock, Moses stood up for them and watered their sheep himself.

"A well again!" Malani said.

"Just like Rebekah," Grandma smiled. Moses married one of the sisters, **Zipporah**, the daughter of a priest named **Jethro**, and became a shepherd.

Meanwhile, back in Egypt, the Israelites cried out under their slavery.

> *"God heard their groaning and he remembered his covenant with Abraham, with Isaac and with Jacob."*
>
> —Exodus 2:24

Joesiah sat up straight. "Abraham, Isaac and Jacob! That's the whole book!"

"That's the whole book," Grandma said. "God never forgot His promise."

One day, while Moses was watching the sheep near **Horeb**, the mountain of God, he saw something strange: a bush on fire that did not burn up. When Moses came closer, God called to him from the bush: "Take off your sandals, for the place where you are standing is holy ground."

God said He had seen the misery of His people and heard them crying out. He was sending Moses to bring them out of Egypt.

But Moses was afraid. "Who am I?" he asked. He said he wasn't a good speaker.

When Moses asked God's name, God answered:

> "I AM WHO I AM."
>
> —Exodus 3:14

▼ TEXT CONTINUES — chapter is about 105 words too long for one page ▼

READ IT FOR YOURSELF

Exodus 2:11–25, Exodus 3 and Exodus 4:10–17

ILLUSTRATION COMING

CHAPTER 11

The Burning Bush

Moses, barefoot, kneels before the burning bush; his sheep graze nearby.

Art size: 2,550 × 3,400 px or larger · no text in the artwork

CHAPTER 12

"Let My People Go"

Moses and Aaron walked into Pharaoh's palace and gave him God's message:

> *"This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'Let my people go.'"*
>
> —Exodus 5:1

Pharaoh sneered. "Who is the LORD, that I should obey him?" Instead of letting the people go, he made their work even harder. Now they had to gather their own straw to make the same number of bricks.

Joesiah crossed his arms. "That's not fair!"

"No," Grandma said. "But watch what God does."

God sent plagues on Egypt, one after another, and each time Moses gave Pharaoh another chance to let the people go.

Malani counted on her fingers as Grandma named them:

BLOOD • FROGS • GNATS • FLIES • SICK LIVESTOCK • BOILS • HAIL • LOCUSTS • DARKNESS

"FROGS!" Malani giggled. "In the beds!"

"Even in the ovens," Grandma laughed. "But this was serious. Again and again, Pharaoh promised to let the people go, and again and again his heart was hard."

Then God warned of a tenth plague, the last and most terrible one. That night, the firstborn in every Egyptian household would die.

God gave Israel instructions. Each family was to choose a lamb, share a meal, and put some of the lamb's blood on the sides and top of their doorframe.

> *"When I see the blood, I will pass over you."*
>
> —Exodus 12:13

That night, the Israelite families ate their meal dressed and ready to leave, with flat bread made without yeast, because there was no time to wait for the dough to rise. At midnight, the tenth plague came. But God passed over every home marked by the blood.

Grandma's voice grew quiet. "It was a night of great sorrow in Egypt. We should never forget that families there were hurting too."

Joesiah nodded slowly.

Finally, Pharaoh called for Moses and Aaron and told them to take the people and go.

▼ TEXT CONTINUES — chapter is about 50 words too long for one page ▼

READ IT FOR YOURSELF

Exodus 5:1–9, Exodus 7–11 (the plagues) and Exodus 12:1–42

ILLUSTRATION COMING

CHAPTER 12

"Let My People Go"

An Israelite family shares the Passover meal by lamplight, dressed and ready to travel.

Art size: 2,550 × 3,400 px or larger · no text in the artwork

CHAPTER 13

A Path Through the Sea

The Israelites left Egypt, a great crowd of men, women and children with their flocks and herds. The Bible says many other people went with them too.

Joesiah perked up. "Other people? Not just Israelites?"

"Not just Israelites," Grandma said. "God's freedom story had room for others too."

God led them with a **pillar of cloud** by day and a **pillar of fire** by night, so they could travel any time.

But back in Egypt, Pharaoh changed his mind again. He gathered his chariots and soldiers and chased after them. Soon the Israelites were trapped, with the sea in front of them and Pharaoh's army behind them.

The people were terrified. But Moses said:

> *"Do not be afraid. Stand firm and you will see the deliverance the LORD will bring you today… The LORD will fight for you; you need only to be still."*
>
> —EXODUS 14:13–14

Then Moses stretched out his hand over the sea. All that night, God sent a strong east wind. The waters divided, and the Israelites walked through the sea on **dry ground**, with a wall of water on their right and on their left!

Malani's mouth fell open. "WALLS of water!"

"Walls of water," Grandma whispered.

When Pharaoh's army followed them into the sea, the waters flowed back, and Israel was safe on the other side.

Then **Miriam**, Moses' sister, the same girl who once watched over baby Moses in the reeds, picked up a tambourine. All the women followed her, dancing and singing:

> *"Sing to the LORD, for he is highly exalted."*
>
> —EXODUS 15:21

Malani jumped up and twirled around the room, shaking an imaginary tambourine. "This is my favorite part!"

Everyone laughed and clapped along.

Joesiah grinned. "Miriam watched over Moses when he was a baby, and now she's leading the celebration."

▼ TEXT CONTINUES — chapter is about 60 words too long for one page ▼

READ IT FOR YOURSELF

Exodus 12:37–38, Exodus 13:17–22, Exodus 14 and Exodus 15:19–21

ILLUSTRATION COMING

CHAPTER 13

A Path Through the Sea

Miriam dances with her tambourine on the far shore; walls of water and the pillar of fire behind.

Art size: 2,550 × 3,400 px or larger · no text in the artwork

CHAPTER 14

Freedom With a Purpose

Three months after leaving Egypt, the Israelites camped at the foot of **Mount Sinai**. There, God spoke to them:

> *"You yourselves have seen what I did to Egypt, and how I carried you on eagles' wings and brought you to myself."*
>
> —Exodus 19:4

Then God gave them the **Ten Commandments**. And listen to how they begin:

> *"I am the LORD your God, who brought you out of Egypt, out of the land of slavery. You shall have no other gods before me."*
>
> —Exodus 20:2–3

Joesiah thought about it. "God reminded them He set them free *before* He told them the rules."

"Exactly," Grandma said. "God's commandments weren't new chains. They were a way to live free: to love God, and to love and respect each other."

Then Grandma turned to one more verse.

> *"Miriam and Aaron began to talk against Moses because of his Cushite wife, for he had married a Cushite."*
>
> —Numbers 12:1

Joesiah's head popped up. "Cush! We learned about Cush in the first book!"

"We did," Grandma smiled. "Cush was connected with the lands south of Egypt: Nubia and Kush. Some Bible readers believe this was Zipporah. Others believe Moses married again. But when Miriam and Aaron spoke against Moses, God was not pleased with them."

Grandma unrolled the family tree one last time. "Look how far we've come."

ABRAHAM *A covenant begins*
ISAAC *The promise continues*
JACOB *A family grows*
EGYPT AND ISRAEL *A nation is formed*
MOSES *A people are freed*

"God made a promise to one man who had no children," Grandma said, "and generations later, a whole nation walked out of slavery into freedom."

Malani held up her fingers. "Promise... kept!"

▼ TEXT CONTINUES — chapter is about 185 words too long for one page ▼

READ IT FOR YOURSELF

Exodus 19:1–6, Exodus 20:1–17 and Numbers 12:1–10

ILLUSTRATION COMING

CHAPTER 14

Freedom With a Purpose

Mount Sinai at dawn: Moses carries the stone tablets; the family-tree scroll on a rock below.

Art size: 2,550 × 3,400 px or larger · no text in the artwork

ILLUSTRATION COMING

BOOK 3 PREVIEW PAGE

Book 3 preview: our three on a hill at sunset, a road from Sinai toward Bethlehem under a bright star.

Art size: 2,550 × 3,400 px or larger · no text in the artwork